

Prompt cards

Twelve prompts. Print, cut along the lines, keep the stack on the desk. Read them out as they are. Square brackets mark what you replace.

1. Orient the agent

PROMPT

Read `data/counts.tsv` and `data/sample_metadata.tsv`. Tell me what these files contain, how many genes and samples there are, and anything unusual you notice. Do not write code yet.

2. Ask for a plan before code

PROMPT

Describe the analysis steps you propose, in order, with a reason for each one. Do not write any code until I agree.

3. Make it run, and show the output

PROMPT

Run it and show me the actual output. Do not summarize it.

4. Ask why this method

PROMPT

Why did you choose [method] rather than [alternative]? What would change in the result if you had used the other one? Show me the difference rather than describing it.

5. Ask what it decided on your behalf

PROMPT

List every decision you made in this analysis that I did not specify, and the value you chose for each one.

6. Ask for a self-review

PROMPT

List the assumptions in this analysis. State what would make the result incorrect. State what you did not check.

7. Ask for the level of confidence

PROMPT

How confident are you in this result, and what would raise or lower that confidence?

8. Separate the data from prior knowledge

PROMPT

Which of the statements you just made are supported by the files in this repository, and which come from your prior knowledge?

9. Check a number by hand

PROMPT

Show me the calculation for [gene], step by step, from the raw counts to the final adjusted p-value.

10. Ask it to break its own result

PROMPT

What is the strongest argument that this result is wrong? What would you check first if a reviewer challenged it?

11. Turn a conversation into something reproducible

PROMPT

Put everything we have done into one script that runs from raw data to final figures. Add comments explaining each decision. Then run the script from the start and confirm the output matches.

12. Recover from a mistake

PROMPT

That is not what I asked for. Here is what is wrong: [description]. Go back to [step] and do it again.